



COVER STORY

LEADERSHIP FOR THE 21ST CENTURY

GALA DINNER

Power lunches, starry nights



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Elegance and excellence don't usually sit well with each other. But for three glittering days at the INDIA TODAY Conclave, style met substance as ministers, industrialists and actors greeted each other, in between addressing delegates, fielding questions, even discussing business. From the affable cricketer Adam Gilchrist who presented a business plan to the Mumbai IPL team's new owner, Mukesh Ambani, to chicken farmer-turned-motorcycle guru Sadhguru Jaggi Vasudev who invited actor Preity Zinta to his ashram in Coimbatore, it was a time for networking.

While Oscar winner Al Gore and Oscar nominee Aamir Khan praised each other's films, the former US vice-president, a second-time visitor to the Conclave, was deep in conversation with Parmeshwar Godrej, whose trademark beret was in place. The head table at the gala dinner on the final day was a magnet for the rest of the room, as delegates kept flocking to

ALL EARS: (From left) Anand Sharma, Zinta, Aiyar, Reddy, Patel, Khan and Vasudev listen to Gore

it to meet the stars who shone under the eco-friendly pale green lights. Co-owner of the freshly-minted Mohali IPL team Zinta, wearing a black jacket over a tube-top and her favourite patent leather Principles shoes, talked animatedly to Civil Aviation Minister Praful Patel, while the tussar sari-clad Nandita Das discussed both her green leanings and the film she is currently directing with Adi Godrej of the Godrej Group. Billionaire scientist Craig Venter, the first and only man to have mapped his own DNA, having wowed the audience with his genome magic, came back after a quick meeting with Science and Technology Minister Kapil Sibal, while Panchayati Raj Minister Mani Shankar Aiyar conferred with his colleague Urban Development Minister S. Jaipal Reddy.

Earlier, Finance Minister P. Chidambaram had slipped out